



No More Ghosting on Twitter

The latest Twitter bug has been notifying users whenever they get unfollowed.
<https://digit.in/july19-60>



Tariffs: trouble for Apple

Incoming tariffs from China could lower income and be disadvantageous for Apple.
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RECOMMERCE: A BOOMING STARTUP SECTOR?

Recommerce capitalises on the aspirational nature of consumers

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s aspirational individuals, we Indians, usually want two criteria to be met when we buy electronic

devices, especially smartphones. Firstly, most of us seek 'value for money' purchases. Secondly, most of us crave a certain amount of 'status elevation' when buying devices. The two combined is an ideal situation, and recommerce brings this to customers.

WHAT IS RECOMMERCE?

Recommerce, also known as Reverse Commerce, is an emerging concept

that involves buying, refurbishing and selling of used, or even demo products, online through an e-commerce platform. A recommerce company directly purchases or facilitates the purchase of second-hand gadgets from consumers, making it a C2B model, however, sometimes, they can also purchase demo or display devices from electronic and gadget stores like Chroma, Vijay Sales and more, making this approach B2B. Customers who sell their old or unwanted devices get cash in exchange. Customers who wish to buy refurbished products can own products that may otherwise have been out of their financial reach. Additionally, you also get 6-24 months warranty and assured quality. Companies like Budli, Yaantra, YNew, Cashify and ReGlobe are a few that have captured the Indian recommerce market.

HOW IS IT DIFFERENT FROM CLASSIFIED SITES?

The recommerce business model is starkly different from online classified sites such as OLX, Quikr, eBay, etc.,

even though they are often thought of as similar by the Average-Joe consumer. Online classified sites give web users a platform to sell their old, unused products, so it is actually a C2C business model. Recommerce, on the other hand, sees people selling to a company, which then refurbishes the product and then sells them back to users. Classified sites do not guarantee the sale of products, meanwhile, recommerce has well-defined software to determine the price of products and guarantee the sale of products within the predetermined price range. Companies essentially act as the middlemen in recommerce.

Rohit Bagaria, CVO and founder of Budli.in, an online Indian recommerce platform says, "When using an online classified ad, there is no assurance of genuinity of the buyer or seller, the time period within which the transaction can be completed or price assurance. Often there are fake and stolen devices traded on these channels". Both online classified ads and recommerce essentially cater to the same audience, but their business models, sorting process (with classified sites, having no sorting process) and customer service policies differ extensively. The advantages of using



There is no way to ascertain the quality of devices and authenticity on sites like OLX and Quikr

recommerce sites include access to an instant price quote, guaranteed product sale (if the products meet the predetermined quality bar), and a warranty period for purchased refurbished products. Some recommerce sites even offer free doorstep pickup and guaranteed buy-back of the refurbished product.

QUALITY TESTING AND ASSURANCE PROCESS

When purchasing a used device from customers, recommerce companies